

Citation extracted from LLM report
(CVE- or ATT&CK-shaped identifier)

? **Present in the alert's own**
Evidence Pack text?
(Stage 1: grounding)

yes

GROUNDING

Stage 2 never runs

no

? **Authoritative source reachable,**
with a usable description?
(NVD live / MITRE STIX snapshot)

no

UNVERIFIED

source couldn't confirm
or deny

yes

? **Identifier exists in the**
source at all?

no

FABRICATED

doesn't exist in the
authoritative source

yes

? **Formally withdrawn?**
(NVD REJECTED /
MITRE revoked)

yes

REJECTED / REVOKED

formally withdrawn by
its own authority

no

? **Topical overlap with alert**
evidence ≥ 0.15 ?
(stemmed bag-of-words)

no

REAL_BUT_IRRELEVANT

real identifier, wrong
context for this alert

yes

REAL_AND_PLAUSIBLE

real + topically matches -- this paper's central finding:
the highest-risk class, precisely because it looks correct